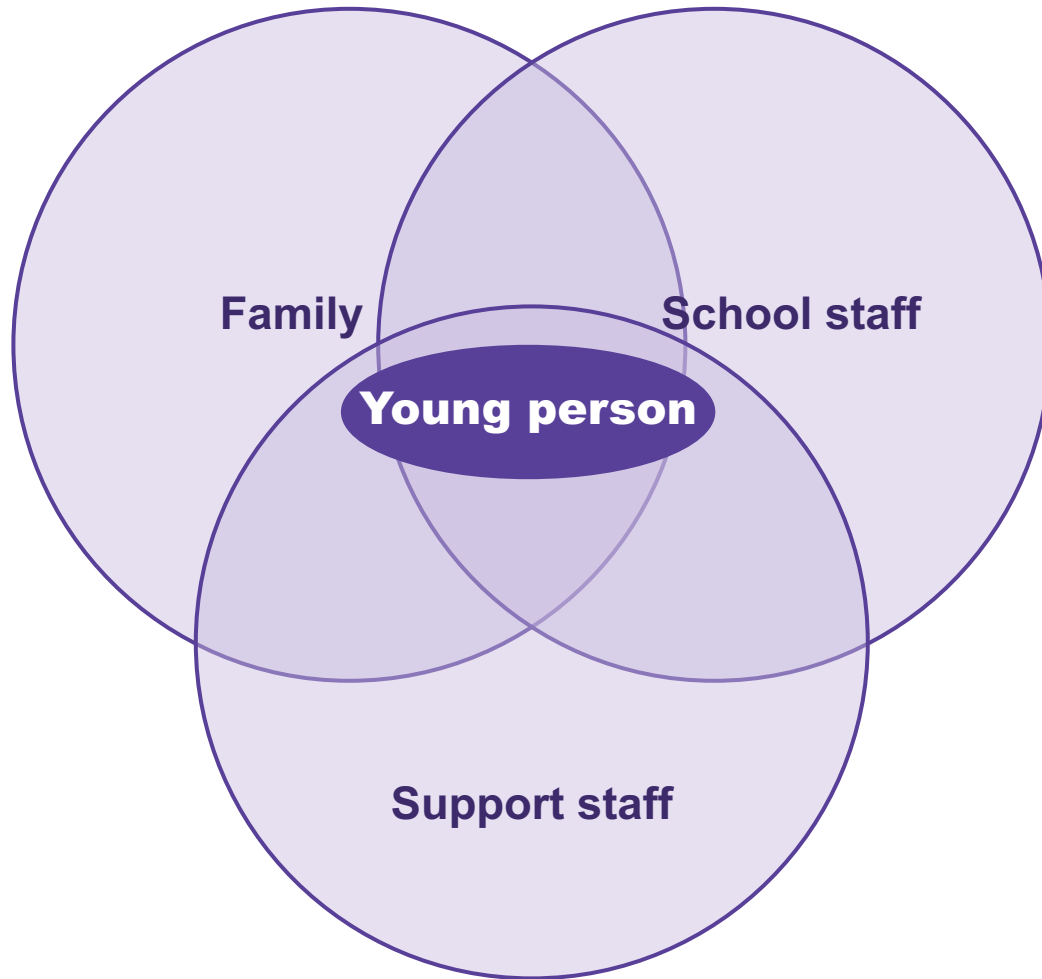




Parents and Carers · Secondary · Session 5

Partnership with the School

Working in partnership



What is the goal of these intersecting partnerships?

Every partner brings different knowledge and a different relationship with your young person.

Your young person is at the centre of every partnership.

Building a home-school partnership

Parents and families are the first and continuing educators of their children

Learning is lifelong and occurs in multiple settings

Partnerships, schools and school communities flourish when the diversity and strengths of families are valued and leveraged

Community engagement expands responsibility and resources

Partnerships grow from mutual trust, respect and responsibility

Partnerships need committed, collaborative and creative leadership

Family-School Partnerships Framework, Department of Education, 2020



What is effective collaboration?

Shared goals

Shared values

Mutual trust and respect

Consult on decision-making



Seeing other perspectives

Invite curiosity: How could we work together so school goes well for my young person?

Centring your young person's voice

Assume good intent

Your rights at school

Disability Discrimination Act 1992

Makes it unlawful to treat someone unfairly because of disability, including in education.

Disability Standards for Education 2005

Schools must consult your young person, or you on their behalf, about reasonable adjustments, so they can take part on the same basis as other students.

What you can ask

How will we be consulted? What adjustments are in place? How and when will they be reviewed? This includes assessments and exams.

Plain-language guides for families are available from the Department of Education.

Power dynamics

Power can sit in:

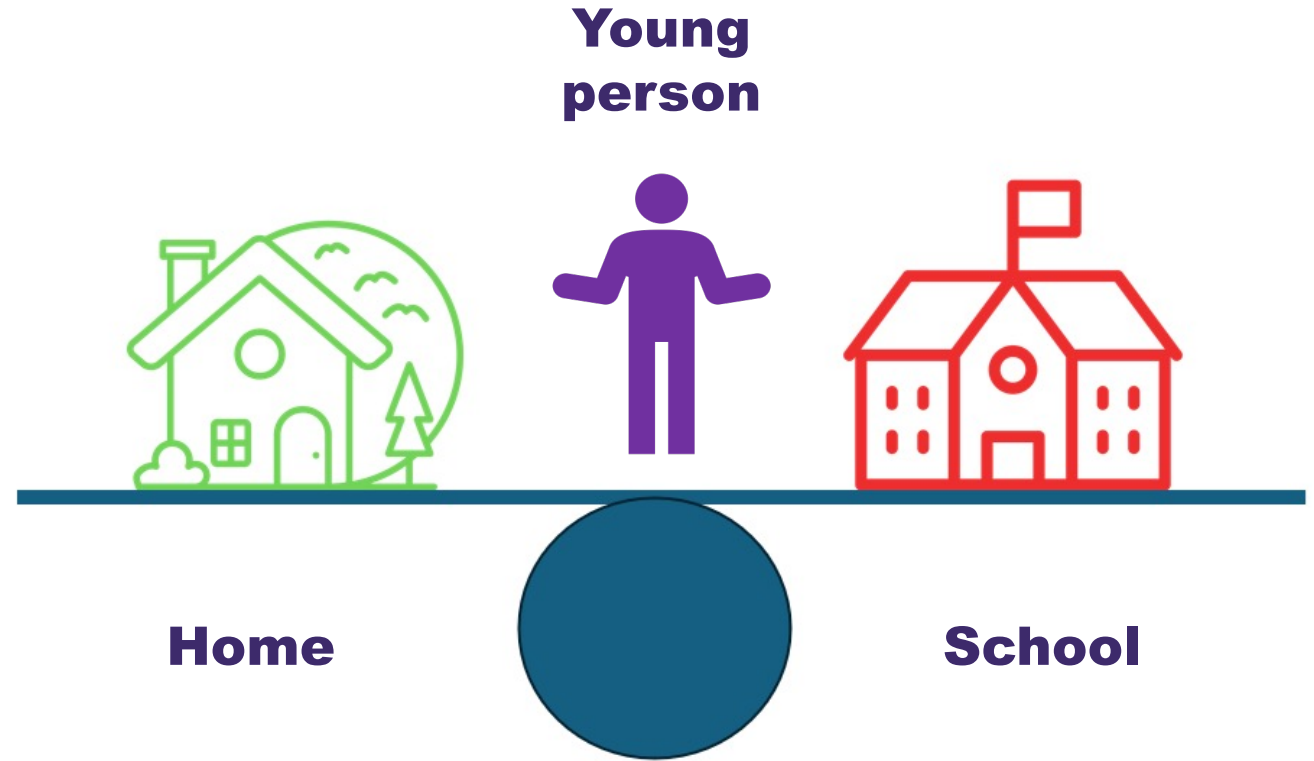
Socio-economic status

Historical / cultural experiences of education

Speaking English vs speaking a language other than English

How school works: teaching approaches and school systems

Perception of the importance / experience of school

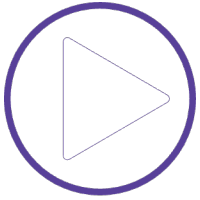


Power dynamics activity

On sticky notes:

- 1 Write an example of an imbalance in power dynamics from a home perspective.
- 2 Write an example of an imbalance in power dynamics from a school perspective.
- 3 Write how you could address these imbalances.

Share at your table, or add your notes to the wall under Home, School and Solutions.



Student voice

What decisions were made, and who made them?

What impact did those decisions have on Adon?



Consultation literacy

Useful consultation includes:

A clear, shared purpose

Open questions

More than one way to contribute

Respect for your knowledge and your young person's

Accurate recording of what was heard

An agreed action, responsibility and follow-up

Ask, listen, and follow up.

Who to contact for what

Secondary schools have more people and more systems. It helps to know who does what.

Day to day

Home room or pastoral care teacher, or year level coordinator.

Learning and adjustments

Learning support or inclusion team.

Wellbeing

Wellbeing staff, school counsellor or psychologist.

Information

The school portal or app for timetables, tasks and messages.

Ask for one main contact person, and how best to reach them.

Adolescents in their own meetings

From being talked about, to taking part and, over time, leading.

Prepared and supported

to take part in their own way: in person, in writing, through a trusted adult.

Taking more of a lead

their own meetings as they move through secondary school.

Speaking up for themselves

is practice for senior school, work and life after school.

Their say matters

in decisions about their own learning and support.

Where you can, help your young person be part of the conversation.

Partnership tools

Working Together Communication Tool

How are we going to communicate as a home school partnership? (Circle or highlight the ones that are most useful to you)	How often are we going to communicate this way and what are we going to communicate about?	Next steps and dates (write in any meetings or planned communication and when they will happen)
 Text		
 Email		
 App		
 Phone		
 Communication book		
 Face to face		
 Other		

Partnership Planning Template

- This template may help parents/carers and school staff to work together. You can tick a box or write down extra ideas.
- The first column lists what has worked well.
- The second column lists what has been challenging.
- The third column lists what could help.

What has worked for you?	What has been challenging?	What could help?
☐ Regular face-to-face catch-ups	☐ Ongoing written communication between home and school	☐ Having a regular time to meet
☐ Regular written feedback, i.e. communication book, reports.	☐ Sharing of goals and concerns	☐ Ongoing written communication between home and school
☐ Regular text messages	☐ Finding a time for parents and schools to speak	☐ Having an advocate or support person at the meetings
☐ Regular emails	☐ Understanding what is important to talk about	☐ Sharing how things are going at home or at school
☐ Regular video conferencing	☐ Feeling heard	☐ Sharing key things that may impact on home or school
☐ Recorded meetings, i.e. audio, video.	☐ Communication, i.e. expressing myself	☐ Voice of the young person being included
☐ Meetings with an advocate	☐ Listening for extended periods of time	☐ List of goals
☐ Group meetings with an advocate	☐ Environment, i.e. fluorescent lighting, noise levels	☐ Different meeting environment
☐ _____	☐ Negative experiences in the past	☐ Visual support for ideas shared in meetings
☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____
☐ _____	☐ _____	☐ _____

NCCD Meetings Tool Kit

A free tool kit to help families and schools prepare for meetings about adjustments: before, during and after the meeting.



The screenshot shows the NCCD website's 'Meetings toolkit' page. The header includes the NCCD logo, the text 'NATIONALLY CONSISTENT COLLECTION OF DATA ON SCHOOL STUDENTS WITH DISABILITY', and 'An Australian Government Initiative'. Navigation links include 'Understanding the NCCD', 'NCCD Phases', 'Resources and tools', 'Professional learning', and 'Help and support'. A search bar is also present. The main content area is titled 'Meetings toolkit' and includes a paragraph about federal law regarding student participation. A sidebar on the left lists related topics: 'assist p', 'monitor', 'Meeting', 'Educati', 'adjustm', 'teacher', and 'expertis'. A callout box titled 'The toolkit' provides an overview and a list of topics covered in the toolkit.

Disability Standards for Education resources  Frequently asked questions My bookmarks  Register Sign in

 **NCCD**
NATIONALLY CONSISTENT COLLECTION OF DATA
ON SCHOOL STUDENTS WITH DISABILITY

 An Australian Government Initiative

Search  Search

Home Understanding the NCCD NCCD Phases Resources and tools Professional learning Help and support

Resources and tools / Wider support materials / Meetings toolkit Was this resource helpful to you?  203

Meetings toolkit

Federal law states that students with disability have the right to be consulted before the education provider makes adjustments to enable them to participate in education on the same basis as students without disability. Anyone in a personal or professional relationship with the student can ask for a meeting and everyone should know the purpose of the meeting and who will attend. Talking through the issues and using an agenda can assist p monitor Meeting Educati adjustm teacher expertis

The toolkit

This toolkit contains tips for people who have to organise or attend a meeting.

- > [Requesting a meeting](#)
- > [Managing meetings](#)
- > [Being prepared](#)
- > [Managing emotions](#)
- > [Keeping records](#)
- > [Was the meeting successful?](#)

Other practical supports

Youth mental health and crisis support

Kids Helpline 1800 55 1800

Ages 5-25, and parents

headspace.org.au

Ages 12-25

Lifeline 13 11 14

24-hour crisis support



Autism Connect

National autism helpline



Emotional, practical and
financial support for carers.
Call 1800 422 737.

Transition planning starts early

Senior years

Subject choices and pathways shape what comes next. Start talking in the middle years.

After school

Further study, training, work and other options. Include your young person in every step.

Who can help

Careers staff, learning support, and disability and employment services.

Prepare for a conversation with school



Prepare for one purposeful conversation.

- What needs to be understood?
- What question will open the conversation?
- How will your young person take part, or have their views included?
- What can be decided together?
- How and when will we follow up?

Bring these notes to Session 6.